A-A-51026
20 September 1985

COMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

NEEDLE, SUTURE, VETERINARY, SURGEONS'

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers one suture needle for veterinary surgical procedures.

Salient characteristics:

The needle shall be a non-sterile, 3/8 circle, Surgeons' regular eye cutting edge needle, for suturing and spaying procedures in horses during veterinary surgical procedures. The length of the needle before bending shall be 4 ± 1/8 inch and the wire size shall be 0.072 ± 0.002 inch.

The needle shall be fabricated from AISI type 420 or 440A corrosion-resisting steel. The needle shall have a Rockwell hardness of C50-C55, following proper stress relief and passivation.

There shall be no evidence of corrosion in the eye, shaft or tip when subjected to the boil test and copper sulfate test as specified in Federal Specification GG-I-526.

The needle shall have a smooth, polished finish, free from burs, feathered edges, hooks, and slivers.

There shall be no evidence of cracks, uneven bends, or fractures when tested in accordance with ASTM E-290-81.

The needle shall be reusable and capable of repeated sterilization by cold liquid processes or gas procedures.

Workmanship. The suture needle shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package, containing twelve (12) needles, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the

FSC 6515

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performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one needle.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U. S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations

Recovered materials. The offeror contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document.

6515-01-201-6993

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians.

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - Mb

Agent:

DLA - DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY

VA-OSS

58331

Project No. 6515-3338

Location S1-8-10

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